

Leona Chen

(412) 426-5355 | leonachen24@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/leona-chen](https://www.linkedin.com/in/leona-chen) | leonachen.dev | github.com/leonac24

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University, Schreyer Honors College

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Mathematics | GPA: 3.74/4.00

Master's in Data Science (Integrated Undergraduate-Graduate Program)

University Park, PA

May 2028

May 2028

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Operating Systems, Systems Programming, Database Management, Computer Vision

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, C, C++, SQL, Swift, R, MATLAB, Verilog, HTML/CSS, Lua

Frameworks & Libraries: React, Next.js, React Native, FastAPI, Node.js, pandas, TensorFlow, LangChain, Tailwind CSS, Vite

Tools & Platforms: Git, Docker, Linux, PostgreSQL, Firebase, Vercel, CI/CD, Hugging Face, VS Code, Xcode

WORK EXPERIENCE

GameChanger (Dick's Sporting Goods)

New York, NY

Software Engineering Intern, Fan Experience

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Built server-driven UI components and concurrent data-source APIs for a cross-platform mobile/web home screen
- Shipped the React/TypeScript client framework that parses, validates, and routes server-declared UI actions
- Created metadata-driven view auto-refresh that preserves the last good render through failed background refetches
- Cut ~1,500 lines of dead code by retiring 7 rolled-out feature flags across 3 repos under strict lint/CI standards

James Z. Wang Research Group, Penn State

University Park, PA

Graduate Research Assistant

Jan 2025 – Present

- Generated thousands of large-scale AI prompts via APIs to study cultural influences on emotional expression
- Managed high-throughput data pipelines producing extensive datasets for AI alignment analysis
- Synthesized AI outputs to investigate cross-cultural variations in emotional expression and inform alignment research

IBM

State College, PA

Associate Application Developer Co-Op

Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Implemented custom enterprise MarTech solutions across Adobe Experience Platform, Marketo, and Real-Time CDP
- Translated client needs into scalable technical solutions with integrated cross-channel data and targeted campaigns
- Collaborated with cross-functional consulting teams to engineer marketing automation and optimize performance impact

Code With Klossy

Remote

Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning Instructor Assistant

Mar 2025 – Aug 2025

- Taught basic machine learning principles to 40 high school students of underrepresented genders in technology
- Instructed on supervised learning, image classification, sentiment analysis, neural networks, semantic search, and RAG
- Guided students through deploying capstone projects using tools including Hugging Face, scikit-learn, and TensorFlow

Penn State School of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

University Park, PA

Data Structures Grader

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

- Graded Data Structures assignments in Python for over 200 students and provided actionable feedback
- Guided students through debugging and complex concepts, enhancing understanding and retention
- Collaborated with instructors to refine grading rubrics, streamline workflows, and maintain high-quality course delivery

PROJECTS

[Rethread](#) @ Google Solution Challenge (North America Finalist) | Next.js, React, Firebase, Tailwind

Apr 2026 – Present

- Built full-stack fashion sustainability app in Next.js integrating 6 external APIs across a parallel server-side AI pipeline
- Designed Firebase integration with Google OAuth and Firestore atomic batch writes for user stat aggregation
- Architected serverless REST API with parallel async pipeline, in-memory caching, and rate limiting across 9 endpoints

[NestEgg](#) @ SteelHacks 2026 (2nd Place) | TypeScript, oRPC, Drizzle, PostgreSQL

Sep 2026

- Architected voice banking app backend with Drizzle ORM on Postgres and type-safe oRPC routers with RBAC
- Designed change-request state machine gated by permission tiers with approval, rejection, and timeout flows
- Built integer-cents finance library for safe-to-spend, shortfall projection, and anomaly detection with unit tests

[Lotline](#) @ AI Horizons 2026 AI for Housing Hackathon | Python, FastAPI, React, three.js

Sep 2026

- Built FastAPI backend and GeoPandas ETL pipeline indexing 22K+ vacant housing parcels with Pydantic validation and pytest
- Developed three.js 3D city of Pittsburgh simulator with instanced parcels, drag-and-drop, AABB collision, and setback checks
- Implemented LLM zoning rule extraction with verbatim-quote verification and deed parsing for 15K+ lot dimensions

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

HackPSU

University Park, PA

Full-Stack Developer and Technology Team Organizer

Sep 2025 – Present

- Shipped features across 7 repos in Next.js, NestJS, and Flask for 1k+ participants, sponsors, and organizers
- Built HackPSU Live, a Next.js day-of site with live schedule, auth-gated QR pass, and cached Discord API announcements
- Rewrote NestJS race analytics to bucket free-text entries via parallel parameterized SQL queries in Objection.js
- Implemented TanStack Query polling and a shared useSyncExternalStore clock to prevent hydration mismatches